

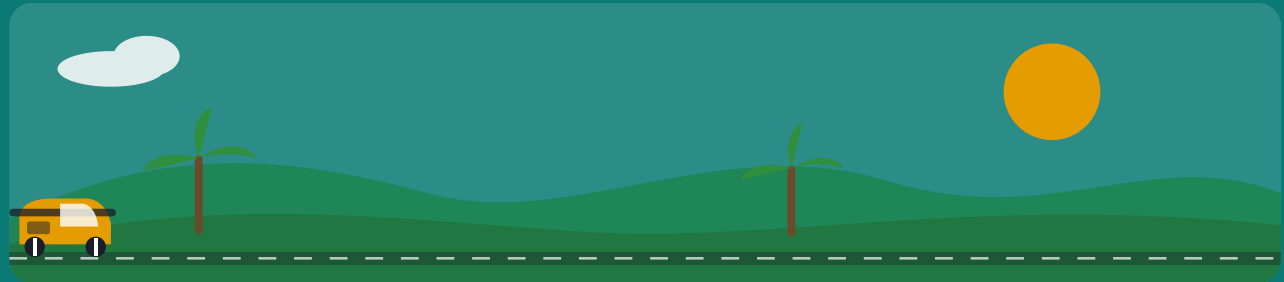
ప్రపంచంలోని మరే దేశానికంటే ముందుగా, ప్రయాణాల కొత్త తరం భారతదేశానికి రాబోతోంది.

The Next Generation of Travel is Coming to India Before Any Other Country On the Planet



The Communications Handbook

Everything in vacario's Fall 2026 plan, as a trip you can take in one sitting. Fourteen stops: the seven channels, the customer's lifecycle and journey, the sales cycles, corporate travel, every workflow and every KPI. Each stop tells you what it is, why it matters and what to try on Monday.



What's inside

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Built from the vacario India Fall 2026 Integrated Sales, Marketing and Promotions Plan. The channel flows are quoted from the plan; lifecycles, journeys, workflows, owners, time limits and KPI targets are proposals for the team to adjust and approve. Benchmarks describe other companies' public programmes as checked in September 2026. The full 88-page explainer holds every detail.

01

STOP 1 · THE BIG PICTURE

The plan in one breath

Every message vacario sends belongs to **one of seven channels**, and each channel has one job, one audience and one path.

The plan asks each channel for clear, measurable objectives and the tactics to reach them. This handbook turns that into a working system: who says what, to whom, where, in which order, and how we know it worked. The rule behind all of it comes straight from the plan: “One company, one source of truth, and one clearly defined communications path from strategy through execution.”



Consumer

01

Travellers, Prospects, Past guests

Vacario → Traveler → App engagement → Booking → Trip → Review / content → Repeat booking

Supply

02

Property owners, Property managers, Hotels, Travel suppliers

Vacario → Owners + managers + hotels + suppliers → Inventory → Availability / pricing → Booking

Creator

03

Influencers, Creators, Campus ambassadors

Vacario → Influencers / creators → Content → Followers → Vacario → Booking

Destination & Merchant

04

Tourism boards, Attractions, Restaurants, Experiences, Local merchants

Vacario → Tourism boards + attractions + restaurants + experiences + merchants → Offers / content → Traveler

Corporate

05

Investors, Media, Governments, Strategic partners, Employees

Vacario → Investors + media + governments + strategic partners + employees

Lifecycle

06

Guests, Suppliers, Creators, Merchants & sponsors

Join → Activate → Engage → Reward → Retain or win back

Internal

07

Leadership, Canada, India, Philippines, All functions

Strategy → Priorities & budgets → Weekly reviews → Daily execution → Reporting → Knowledge base

Tap a card

Each postcard opens its channel at stop 10: messages, workflow, lead flow and KPIs.

🔗 Try this on Monday

1. Before you send any message, name its channel. If it doesn't fit one, it probably shouldn't go out.
2. Find your own name in the “Who owns what” grid at stop 12.
3. Bookmark stop 10 for the channel you work in.

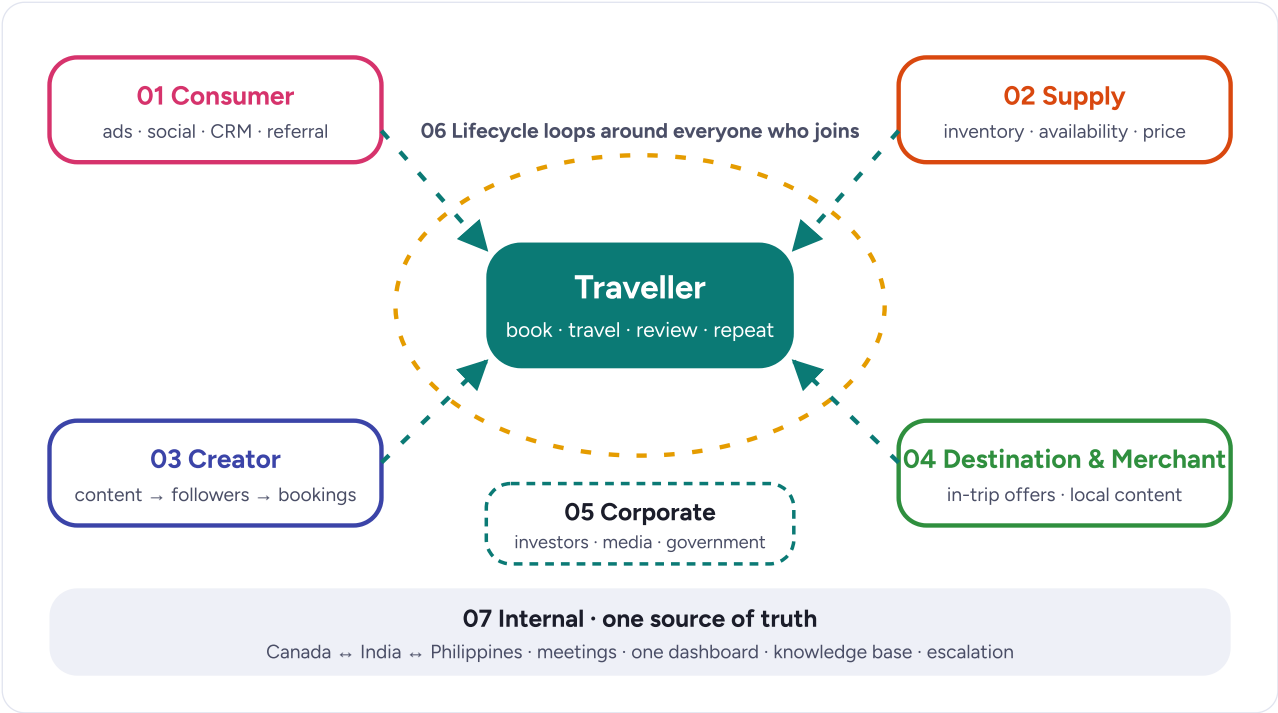
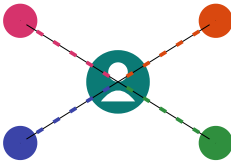
02

STOP 2 · THE SYSTEM

How it all fits together

Four channels feed the traveller’s booking, Lifecycle keeps everyone who joins, Corporate builds trust, and Internal keeps us on one set of numbers.

The arrows below are real handoffs: what one team produces, another team uses. Everything is measured against one north star, the value of trips that actually happen.



OUR NORTH STAR · TRY IT

Completed trips × average booking value = the value of trips people actually took. Type your own numbers; the example values are only a demonstration.

Completed trips this month

Average booking value (₹)

NORTH STAR

500

9000

₹45,00,000

FROM	TO	WHAT MOVES
Supply	→ Consumer	New inventory and destinations to promote
Creator	→ Consumer	Content for ads, CRM and the app feed
Consumer	→ Destination & Merchant	Travellers and trip dates for in-trip offers
Consumer	→ Lifecycle	Guests after the trip
Supply / Creator	→ Lifecycle	Partners after go-live and onboarding
Destination & Merchant	→ Corporate	Tourism board partnerships to announce
All channels	→ Internal	Results, issues, decisions needed
Internal	→ All channels	Priorities, budgets, one set of numbers
Corporate	→ Internal	Staff briefed before any release

 Try this on Monday

1. Say the north star out loud in your next meeting, with this month's number.
2. Pick one handoff your team receives. Ask the sending team what "good" looks like for them.
3. If you can't trace your work to one of the four arrows, ask which one it serves.

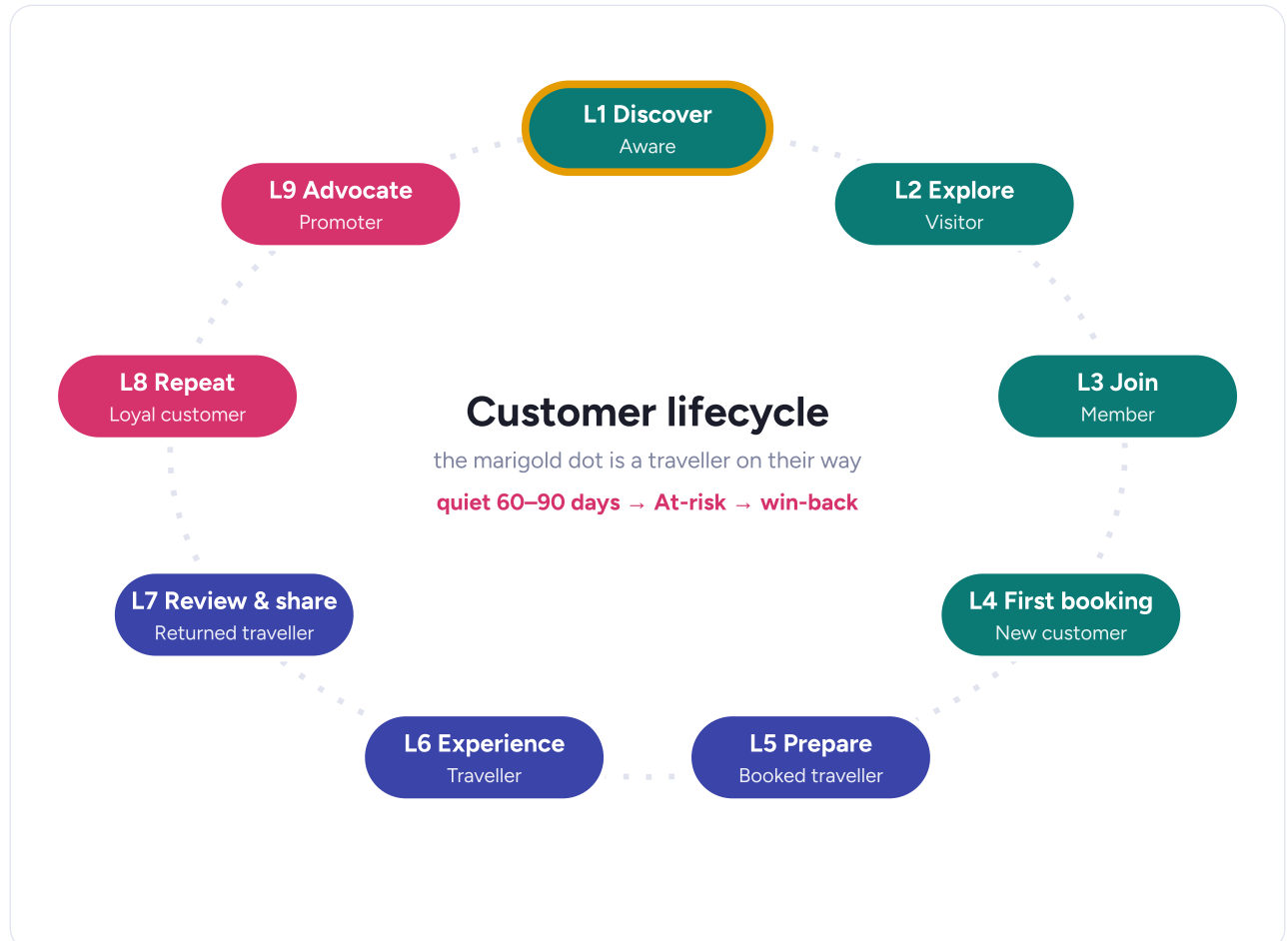
03

STOP 3 · WHERE EACH TRAVELLER IS

The customer lifecycle

Nine stages, from first seeing vacario to recommending it. Each has a rule for getting in, a rule for getting out, and one owner.

Because every stage has an entry rule, we can count how many people are in it. Because it has an exit rule, everyone knows what “moving them on” means. Tap a stage to see its rules, messages, owner and KPIs.



L1 · AWARE

Discover

"Where could I go next? Is this a brand I can trust?"

GETS IN WHEN

Has seen Vacario at least once: an ad, a creator post, press, a friend's link.

MOVES ON WHEN

Visits the app or site.

OUR JOB

Inspire with real destinations and stays, and earn the first visit.

OWNER

Performance marketing

WE SAY

Next-generation travel, India first · Real stays, real prices, real reviews

MEASURED BY

Reach · Cost per install (CPI)

Benchmark: MakeMyTrip's Myra plans trips conversationally in eight Indian languages.

L2 · VISITOR

Explore

"Is there something here for my budget and my group?"

GETS IN WHEN

Visited the app or site, or installed the app, without an account.

MOVES ON WHEN

Creates an account, or leaves for 30 days (back to Discover).

OUR JOB

Show relevant destinations fast and make signing up worth it.

OWNER

Product + performance marketing

WE SAY

See member prices · Save trips you like

MEASURED BY

Sign-up rate

Benchmark: EaseMyTrip earned trust with no convenience fee on flights: show all-in prices early.

L3 · MEMBER

Join

"Let me look around before I commit."

GETS IN WHEN

Created an account.

MOVES ON WHEN

Makes a first booking. No booking in 90 days moves the member to At-risk.

OUR JOB

Learn what they want and help them to a first booking.

OWNER

CRM lead

WE SAY

Welcome: tell us how you travel · Your first-booking offer · Price drop on a trip you saved

MEASURED BY

Opt-in rate · 30-day booking conversion · Activation rate

L4 · NEW CUSTOMER

First booking

"Did it go through? What happens now?"

GETS IN WHEN

Paid for a first booking.

MOVES ON WHEN

Moves to Pre-trip at once.

OUR JOB

Confirm instantly and remove every doubt.

OWNER

Product + customer service

WE SAY

You're booked: itinerary, invoice, help line · Here's what happens next

MEASURED BY

Blended CAC · Average booking value

Benchmark: Booking.com and Airbnb confirm instantly; confirmation is the first moment of trust.

L5 · BOOKED TRAVELLER

Prepare

"How do I get there? What should we do?"

GETS IN WHEN

Has a confirmed booking with a future check-in.

MOVES ON WHEN

Checks in (In-trip) or cancels (back to Member).

OUR JOB

Prepare them well and add useful extras.

OWNER

CRM lead

WE SAY

7 days to go: directions, weather, tips · Things to do near your stay

MEASURED BY

Ancillary revenue per trip

L6 · TRAVELLER

Experience

"Is this as promised? Who helps me if not?"

GETS IN WHEN

Checked in.

MOVES ON WHEN

Checks out.

OUR JOB

Be useful during the trip and fix problems fast.

OWNER

Customer service + destination partnerships

WE SAY

Need anything? We reply in minutes · Tonight nearby: offers for you

MEASURED BY

In-trip view rate · Redemption rate

Benchmark: Airbnb AirCover: comparable stay or refund if check-in fails.

L7 · RETURNED TRAVELLER

Review & share

"That was great (or not). Should I tell people?"

GETS IN WHEN

Checked out in the last 30 days.

MOVES ON WHEN

After 30 days moves to Repeat track (Lifecycle).

OUR JOB

Collect the review, fix anything that went wrong, invite sharing and referral.

OWNER

Community & social

WE SAY

How was your stay?

- Share your photos
- Give ₹X, get ₹X

MEASURED BY

Review rate · Referral share · NPS by audience

Benchmark: Booking.com verified-stay reviews; Airbnb's 14-day double-blind reviews.

L8 · LOYAL CUSTOMER

Repeat

"Where to next? Do they remember me?"

GETS IN WHEN

Two or more bookings in the last 12 months.

MOVES ON WHEN

Refers someone who books (Advocate), or goes quiet (At-risk).

OUR JOB

Make the next trip easy and rewarding.

OWNER

CRM lead

WE SAY

Trip ideas from your last stay · Member prices and points · Long weekends and festivals

MEASURED BY

12-month repeat rate · Loyalty share

Benchmark: Booking.com Genius and Expedia One Key reward trips, not just spend.

L9 · PROMOTER

Advocate

"I love this. I want my friends to try it."

GETS IN WHEN

Referred at least one friend who booked, or scored 9–10 on NPS and shared content.

MOVES ON WHEN

Stays an advocate while active; goes to At-risk like anyone else.

OUR JOB

Recognise, reward and give them reasons to keep sharing.

OWNER

CRM lead + community

WE SAY

Thank you: here's a reward · Be first to try new destinations

MEASURED BY

Referral share · NPS by audience

Benchmark: MMTBLACK gives top customers priority support and upgrades.

🔗 Try this on Monday

1. Pick one stage you influence. Write down how many people are in it today.
2. Check that every message you send names the stage it is for.
3. Look at the At-risk rule: who on your team calls a traveller who has gone quiet for 60 days?

04

STOP 4 · RESPECT THE TRAVELLER

House rules for every message



People stay when messages feel welcome. Six rules keep them welcome, and service always beats sales.

These rules apply to every channel. Lifecycle owns the calendar of who hears what, so nobody gets five messages in one day from five teams. When travellers go quiet, the states below say exactly what happens next.



Frequency

At most one marketing message a day per person, across all touchpoints; at most three marketing WhatsApp messages a week.



Quiet hours

No marketing messages between 9 pm and 9 am IST. Service messages (booking, safety) may go any time.



Consent first

WhatsApp, SMS and push marketing only to people who opted in for that touchpoint. Consent is recorded with time and wording.



Service beats sales

Nobody with an open complaint gets a marketing message until it is resolved.



One voice

Lifecycle owns the calendar of who gets what; other channels book slots in it instead of sending directly.



Language

English plus the traveller's chosen language (for example Telugu or Hindi) where templates exist.

At-risk

When: A member with no app visit in 60 days and no upcoming trip, or a customer with no booking in 9 months.

We: Personal offer or message within 7 days of the flag; ask what changed.

Lapsed

When: No booking in 18 months and no visit in 90 days, after two win-back attempts.

We: Move to a quarterly "what's new" message only, to protect deliverability and respect the customer.

Won back

When: An At-risk or Lapsed customer who books again.

We: Treat as Repeat; note what brought them back in the knowledge base.

Q Try this on Monday

1. Count the marketing messages one test traveller got last week. More than seven? Talk to Lifecycle.
2. Check that nobody with an open complaint is on this week's campaign list.
3. Make sure every WhatsApp list you use has recorded consent.

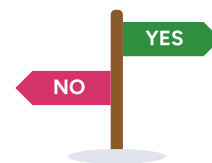
05

STOP 5 · EVERY "NO" HAS A NEXT STEP

Play the path: yes or no

Pick a path and answer each question. Follow "yes" to move on; every "no" shows exactly what the team does next, so no one is ever left without a step.

The same yes/no logic runs through every flow in this handbook: the traveller, a business trip, a MICE event, a new property, a travel agency and an incoming enquiry. Playing it once is the fastest way to learn it.



Traveller

1. Sees Vacario (ad, creator, friend, press)

2. ♦ Visits the app or site?

No → Retarget with a different destination or creator; stay in Discover (Discover)

3. ♦ Creates an account?

No → Remind of member prices; retarget for 30 days, then back to Discover (Explore)

4. ♦ Books within 30 days?

No → Welcome nudges at 24 h, 72 h, 7 days; no booking in 90 days → At-risk (Join / At-risk)

5. ♦ Travels as planned (not cancelled)?

No → Refund per policy; offer to rebook with a credit (Join)

6. ♦ Happy with the stay (4–5 stars)?

No → Service recovery (W5) within the day; supplier told; ask again after the fix (Recovery)

7. Review, photos and referral link sent (W3, W4)

8. ♦ Books again within 12 months?

No → At-risk at 9 months → win-back offer; no response after two tries → Lapsed (At-risk / Lapsed)

9. ♦ Refers a friend who books?

No → Stay a Repeat customer; invite again after the next great trip (Repeat)

10. Advocate: rewarded, recognised, first to try new destinations

Business trip

1. Employee requests a trip (dates, city, purpose)

2. ♦ Within the company's travel policy?

No → Send to the approver with the reason and a policy-compliant alternative (Approval)

3. ♦ Approver says yes? (only if outside policy)

No → Traveller changes the request or the trip is cancelled; reason logged (Request)

4. ♦ Preferred flight and hotel available at policy price?

No → Corporate desk offers the next-best options within 1 hour (Booking)

5. Booked: itinerary, GST details and duty-of-care contact sent

6. ♦ Change or problem during the trip?

No → Trip runs as booked (Settlement)

7. Yes: 24/7 corporate desk rebooks within policy and tells the travel manager

8. ♦ Invoice matches the booking and GST details?

No → Corrected invoice within 2 working days (Settlement)

9. Monthly report: spend, savings, policy compliance

10. ♦ Account renews at year end?

No → Exit review: what went wrong, what would win it back (Lost account)

11. Renewed account: new rates, updated policy, quarterly reviews

MICE event

1. **Company enquires about a meeting, incentive trip, conference or exhibition**
2. **◆ Dates, group size, city and budget workable?**
No → Suggest other dates, cities or formats; refer out if we can't serve it (Closed or re-briefed)
3. Brief agreed; proposal with venues, rooms, travel, activities and costs within 5 working days
4. **◆ Proposal accepted?**
No → Revise up to twice; if still no, close with the reason (Lost (reason logged))
5. **◆ Site inspection wanted?**
No → Go straight to contract (Contract)
6. Yes: site visit hosted within 10 days
7. **◆ Contract signed and deposit paid by the hold date?**
No → Room and venue holds released; client told in writing (Closed)
8. Planning: rooming list, agenda, transport, food, branding; attendee invitations and registration
9. **◆ Final numbers confirmed by the cut-off?**
No → Apply the agreed attrition terms; adjust rooms and catering (Planning)
10. Event delivered with an on-site desk and a daily client check-in
11. **◆ Client and attendee satisfaction on target?**
No → Recovery call within 48 hours; credit per contract where due (Post-event)
12. **◆ Books the next event?**
No → Stay in touch quarterly with ideas and dates (Nurture)
13. **Repeat client: next event briefed, account plan updated**

Property onboarding

1. **Property found in a priority destination**
2. **◆ Meets our quality and location standard?**
No → Not pursued now; recorded for a future review (Not a fit)
3. **◆ Owner interested after the first conversation?**
No → Nurture: case study and a follow-up in 90 days (Nurture list)
4. **◆ Agrees commission, payout and parity terms?**
No → One revised proposal; if still no, close with the reason (Lost (reason logged))
5. **◆ Documents complete (PAN, GST, bank, ownership)?**
No → Onboarding paused; BD chases within 3 days (Signed, waiting)
6. Listing built: photos, rates, availability, channel manager
7. **◆ Passes QA and a test booking?**
No → Back to onboarding with a fix list (Onboarding)
8. Live and announced to Consumer marketing
9. **◆ First booking within 30 days?**
No → Check price, photos and demand; add to a promotion (Live, not activated)
10. **Activated partner: monthly statements, quarterly growth reviews**

Travel agency

1. **Agency identified (association, fair, referral)**
2. **◆ Registered business with valid GST?**
No → Not onboarded; invite back once registered (Not eligible)
3. **◆ Interested after the pitch?**
No → Nurture: newsletter and a fam-trip invite in 90 days (Nurture list)
4. **◆ Agrees commission and payment terms?**
No → Offer prepaid terms instead of credit; else close with reason (Lost)
5. Portal access, training and marketing kit
6. **◆ Completes training?**
No → Reminder and a short one-to-one session (Onboarding)
7. **◆ First booking within 30 days?**
No → Account manager call; share best-selling stays for their customers (Activation)
8. **◆ Pays on time and within the credit limit?**
No → Move to prepaid; repeat breaches → exit (Prepaid / exit)
9. **◆ Hits the next tier's booking level?**
No → Stay on the current tier; quarterly review plan (Current tier)
10. **Higher tier: better commission, fam trips, featured deals**

Enquiry

1. **Traveller sends an enquiry (form, WhatsApp, call, chat)**
2. Automatic acknowledgement within 1 minute
3. **◆ Dates, group size and budget known?**
No → Travel desk asks in the first conversation; no reply in 24 h → CRM nurture (Nurture)
4. **◆ Can we serve it well (destination, dates, budget)?**
No → Suggest the closest alternative; if none, say so honestly and stay in touch (Alternative or closed)
5. Consultation, then a quote with 2–3 options within 2 hours
6. **◆ Accepted within 48 hours?**
No → Ask what would change their mind; one revised quote (Revise once)
7. **◆ Revised quote accepted?**
No → Close with the reason (price, dates, went elsewhere); CRM nurture (Lost (reason logged))
8. **◆ Payment completed?**
No → Payment help within 30 minutes; hold the price for 24 hours (Payment help)
9. **Booked: confirmation sent, customer enters the Prepare stage (L5)**

🔔 Try this on Monday

1. Play the path for the flow you own and note every “no” your team handles today without a written next step.
2. Pick one “no” and put its time limit on your team board.
3. Share this stop with a new joiner on day one.

06

STOP 6 · ONE TRIP, FROM THEIR SIDE

The customer journey

The lifecycle says where a traveller is; the journey says **what the trip feels like to them**. We design every message for the moment it arrives.

The curve shows how the traveller feels at each stage (a planning estimate to test with real research). The dips are where things go wrong, and where we have to be at our best. Tap a stage to see what they want, think and feel, and what we do about it.





BEFORE THE TRIP · L1

Discover

“Where could I go next? Is this a brand I can trust?”

THEY WANT

Find an idea worth a trip

THEY FEEL (3/5)

Curious, a little unsure

THEY DO

Scrolls Reels, searches “weekend trips near me”, hears from friends

WHERE THEY MEET US

Instagram Reels, YouTube, Google search, creator posts, friends’ WhatsApp shares, news

WHAT GOES WRONG

Too many choices, not sure who to trust

WHAT WE DO

Show real stays with real prices in the traveller’s language. Real stays and real reviews in every ad and creator post.

“3 hill homestays under ₹6,000 a night, 4 hours from Hyderabad.”

Measured by Reach · CPI · owner: Performance marketing

BEFORE THE TRIP · L2

Explore

“Is there something here for my budget and my group?”

THEY WANT

Check if it suits my budget and group

THEY FEEL (3/5)

Interested but comparing

THEY DO

Browses stays, compares prices with other sites

WHERE THEY MEET US

App, website, stay pages, reviews, price filters, retargeting ads

WHAT GOES WRONG

Hidden fees elsewhere, slow pages

WHAT WE DO

All-in prices, honest photos, verified reviews on every stay. All-in prices shown, fast app, member prices behind sign-up.

“Prices shown include all taxes and fees.”

Measured by Sign-up rate · owner: Product + performance marketing

BEFORE THE TRIP · L3

Join

“Let me look around before I commit.”

THEY WANT

Save options, get the best price

THEY FEEL (4/5)

Hopeful, cautious about spam

THEY DO

Creates an account, saves a few trips

WHERE THEY MEET US

Sign-up, welcome quiz, email, push, WhatsApp (opt-in)

WHAT GOES WRONG

Asked for too much too soon; spammy messages

WHAT WE DO

Ask three questions, then send only what fits them. Three-question welcome quiz, consent asked clearly, one useful message at a time.

“Tell us how you travel and we’ll only send trips that fit.”

Measured by Opt-in rate · 30-day conversion · owner: CRM lead

BEFORE THE TRIP · L4

First booking

“Did it go through? What happens now?”

THEY WANT

Pay and be sure it worked

THEY FEEL (4/5)

Excited, slightly anxious

THEY DO

Pays and waits for confirmation

WHERE THEY MEET US

Checkout, payment, confirmation email and WhatsApp, trip wallet

WHAT GOES WRONG

Anxiety: did it go through? Is the stay real?

WHAT WE DO

Confirm within a minute with everything in one message. Confirmation within one minute with itinerary, invoice and help line.

“You’re booked! Itinerary, invoice and our help line are below.”

Measured by Blended CAC · booking value · owner: Product + customer service

GETTING READY · L5

Prepare

“How do I get there? What should we do?”

THEY WANT

Know how to get there and what to do

THEY FEEL (4/5)

Excited, busy

THEY DO

Plans the route, packs, tells family

WHERE THEY MEET US

T-7 and T-1 messages, directions, weather, experience offers

WHAT GOES WRONG

Missing directions or check-in details

WHAT WE DO

One message with everything; add experiences they'll love. T-7 and T-1 messages with everything in one place.

“7 days to go: route, weather and 3 things locals love nearby.”

Measured by Ancillary revenue per trip · owner: CRM lead

DURING THE TRIP · L6

Experience

“Is this as promised? Who helps me if not?”

THEY WANT

Enjoy it; get help fast if needed

THEY FEEL (5/5)

Happy, or stressed if something fails

THEY DO

Checks in, explores, eats out

WHERE THEY MEET US

WhatsApp support, in-app chat, host contact, nearby offers

WHAT GOES WRONG

A problem at the stay with nobody answering

WHAT WE DO

Reply in 15 minutes, fix in 2 hours, one good offer a day. Human reply within 15 minutes, 24/7, and a fix within 2 hours.

“Anything you need? Reply here, a real person answers.”

Measured by In-trip view rate · redemptions · owner: Customer service + destination partnerships

AFTER THE TRIP · L7

Review & share

“That was great (or not). Should I tell people?”

THEY WANT

Share the memories, settle up

THEY FEEL (4/5)

Satisfied, nostalgic

THEY DO

Shares photos, tells friends, sorts payments

WHERE THEY MEET US

Review request, photo invite, referral link, NPS question

WHAT GOES WRONG

Unresolved issue; review ignored

WHAT WE DO

Thank them, fix anything unresolved, invite them to share. Reply to every review in 48 hours; service recovery for 3 stars or fewer.

“How was Coorg? Share a photo and give a friend ₹500 off.”

Measured by Review rate · NPS · referral share · owner: Community & social

AFTER THE TRIP · L8

Repeat

“Where to next? Do they remember me?”

THEY WANT

Plan the next break

THEY FEEL (4/5)

Loyal if remembered

THEY DO

Thinks about the next holiday

WHERE THEY MEET US

Trip ideas email, festival offers, points balance, member prices

WHAT GOES WRONG

Generic offers that ignore past trips

WHAT WE DO

Suggest trips based on the last one; make points count. Ideas based on the last stay, points that add up.

“You loved Coorg. Chikmagalur is quieter this Diwali.”

Measured by 12-month repeat rate · loyalty share · owner: CRM lead

AFTER THE TRIP · L9

Advocate

"I love this. I want my friends to try it."

THEY WANT

Help friends travel well

THEY DO

Recommends Vacario, posts about trips

THEY FEEL (5/5)

Proud, generous

WHERE THEY MEET US

Referral credits, early access, ambassador invites, creator programme

WHAT GOES WRONG

No thanks for referrals

WHAT WE DO

Recognise them publicly (with permission) and reward every referral. Credits for both, recognition, early access.

"Your friends booked 3 trips. Here's your reward and early access."

Measured by Referral share · NPS · owner: CRM lead + community

💡 Try this on Monday

- 1. Read your team's next message out loud as if you were the traveller at that stage. Does it answer what they're thinking?
- 2. Find the biggest dip in the curve that your team can fix, and fix one thing this week.
- 3. Replace one generic message with the "What we say" line for its stage.

07

STOP 7 · TIMING IS KINDNESS

One trip, message by message

From booking to the next trip, a traveller hears from us at **nine planned moments**, and six of them decide whether they come back.

T is check-in day and C is check-out day. Each message has a job; if it has no job, it doesn't go.



- **Booking** Confirmation within 1 minute: itinerary, GST invoice, help line
Consumer
- **T-7** Directions, weather, packing tips; offers near the stay
Consumer · Destination
- **T-1** Check-in details, host contact, what to do tomorrow
Consumer
- **T (arrival)** "We're here if you need us"; one offer for the evening
Destination
- **During stay** At most one offer a day; support replies within 15 minutes
Destination · Consumer
- **C+1** Review request; problem? personal follow-up the same day
Consumer
- **C+7** Photo and video invite for the feed; referral link
Consumer · Lifecycle
- **C+30** Next-trip ideas; hand over to the Repeat track
Lifecycle
- **C+60** No new booking and no visit? Flag At-risk
Lifecycle

First impression

The first ad or creator post: does it look real and relevant?

Discover

The price moment

All-in price with no surprises at checkout

Explore · Book

The confirmation minute

Instant, complete confirmation removes booking anxiety

Book

Arrival

The stay matches the photos and someone answers if not

Experience

The problem

How fast and fairly an issue is fixed decides if they return

Experience · Review

The thank-you

A reply to their review and a reward for their referral

Review & share · Advocate

💡 Try this on Monday

1. Book a test stay and check you receive each of the nine messages, on time.
2. Time your support team's reply to a test in-trip problem. Under 15 minutes?
3. Look at the last five 3-star reviews: did each get a personal reply within 48 hours?

08

STOP 8 · BRINGING IN WHAT TRAVELLERS NEED

Sales lifecycles



Three sales cycles feed the customer lifecycle: **properties to sell, agents who sell for us, and the enquiries our campaigns generate.**

Each cycle has stages with owners and time limits. Every loss is logged with a reason, and every win is handed straight to the next owner. Play any of them at stop 5.

S1

Property onboarding

Supply is a B2B sale.

- 1 **Prospect** · Target list by day 5 of the month
- 2 **Contacted** · Within 5 working days
- 3 **Discovery** · Within 10 days of contact
- 4 **Qualified** · Decision at discovery
- 5 **Proposal** · Within 3 days of qualifying
- 6 **Negotiation** · Within 10 days
- 7 **Signed** · Within 5 days of agreement
- 8 **Onboarding** · Within 7 days of signing
- 9 **Live** · Within 2 days of onboarding
- 10 **Activated** · 30 days
- 11 **Growing** · Ongoing

Measured by: Sales cycle length · Contact-to-qualified rate · Win rate

[Play this path](#)

S2

Travel agency partner

Many Indian travellers, especially in tier-2 and tier-3 cities and for families, groups and pilgrimages, still book through a local travel agent.

- 1 **Identify** · Monthly target list
- 2 **Outreach** · Within 5 working days
- 3 **Qualify** · At first meeting
- 4 **Agreement** · Within 10 days
- 5 **Onboard** · Within 7 days of signing
- 6 **Activate** · Within 30 days
- 7 **Grow** · Monthly
- 8 **Review** · Quarterly
- 9 **Retain or exit** · Annually

Measured by: Active agents · Agent activation rate · Agent booking share

[Play this path](#)

S3

Enquiry-to-booking

Campaigns, creators, WhatsApp and the website generate enquiries from travellers who want help: a family trip, a honeymoon, a group, a package.

- 1 **Enquiry** · Any time
- 2 **Acknowledged** · Within 1 minute
- 3 **Qualified** · First conversation
- 4 **Consultation** · Within 15 minutes in working hours
- 5 **Quote** · Within 2 hours
- 6 **Follow-up** · At 24 and 44 hours
- 7 **Decision** · Within 48 hours
- 8 **Booked** · Instant after payment
- 9 **Closed or nurtured** · Same day

Measured by: Enquiries by source · Response time · Enquiry-to-quote rate

[Play this path](#)

Q Try this on Monday

1. Open your pipeline and give every open deal one of these stage names.
2. Add a "reason lost" to every deal closed this month.
3. Enquiries: time the reply to one enquiry today. Acknowledged in a minute, human reply in 15?

09

STOP 9 · A NEW LINE OF BUSINESS

Corporate travel: business trips and MICE



A different customer: **the company pays, an employee travels, a travel manager sets the rules** and finance needs GST invoices.

Business trips are individual travel for work; MICE is group travel for meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions. This is a new line, separate from the plan's Corporate Communications channel (which speaks to investors and media). Yatra's 2024 purchase of Globe Travels, a MICE specialist, and MakeMyTrip's myBiz show how seriously India's OTAs take it.

W8

Business-trip lifecycle

1

Account setup

· Within 10 working days of signing

2

Request

· Any time

3

Policy check

· Instant (automatic) or 1 hour

4

Approval

· Within 4 working hours

5

Booking

· Within 2 hours of approval

6

Pre-trip

· T-2 and T-1

7

In-trip support

· Reply within 15 minutes

8

Settlement

· Invoice within 2 working days of check-out

9

Reporting

· By day 5 of each month

10

Review and renewal

· Quarterly; renewal 60 days early

Play this path

W9

MICE event lifecycle

1

Enquiry

· Reply within 1 working day

2

Brief

· Brief agreed within 3 working days

3

Feasibility

· 2 working days

4

Proposal

· Within 5 working days of the brief

5

Site inspection

· Within 10 days of request

6

Contract and deposit

· By the hold date

7

Planning

· Weekly client call until the event

8

Attendee communications

· From 6 weeks before

9

Event delivery

· During the event

10

Post-event

· Report within 10 working days

11

Rebook

· Within 30 days

Play this path

Travel manager / admin

Sets the policy, owns the account, wants control and savings

Traveller (employee)

Wants an easy, comfortable trip and quick help

Approver (manager)

Wants to approve exceptions quickly and see why

Finance / accounts

Wants correct GST invoices, one monthly statement, spend reports

💡 Try this on Monday

1. List five companies in our priority cities whose teams travel monthly: they are the first business-trip prospects.

2. Write the one-page travel-policy checklist the corporate desk will check every request against.

3. Pick one supply partner who could host a 30-person offsite; ask what they would need from us.

10

STOP 10 · PICK YOUR CHANNEL

The seven channels, up close



Each channel below has **what we say, how the work flows, how people move through it, and how we measure it**. Pick one.

Messages come as three pillars with a line you can actually use. Workflow steps show who owns each step and how long it may take. The lead flow shows the stages people move through, with the conversion measured between each.

CHANNEL 01 · FROM THE PLAN

Consumer Communications

Paid advertising, earned media, creator content, social channels, CRM/email, WhatsApp/SMS, push notifications, referral programmes and loyalty communications.

Paid ads, press and creator content bring people to the app. From sign-up, CRM takes over: a welcome series learns what each person wants, and reminders bring back anyone who searched without booking. Once they book, messages switch from selling to helping: confirmation, trip preparation and support during the stay. After checkout the traveller is asked for a review and a referral, and after 30 days they move to Lifecycle, where the aim is the next booking.

Travellers Prospects Past guests

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Priya in Hyderabad sees a Reel about a Coorg homestay and taps the link (1). She installs the app and picks "hills, family, under ₹8,000" in the welcome quiz (2). She searches but does not book; next day a WhatsApp reminder shows a price drop (3) and she books (4). A week before arrival she gets directions and a coffee-plantation tour offer (5). She messages support about a late check-in and gets a reply in minutes (6). After checkout she leaves a review and sends her referral link to her sister (7). A month later she gets Diwali trip ideas and books again (8).

What we say · tone: warm, confident, plain

Discover

Inspiring destinations and real stays, chosen for how Indians travel now.

"Your next long weekend starts here."

Trust

Verified stays, clear prices, instant confirmation and help within minutes.

"What you see is what you get, and we're a message away."

Rewards

Member prices, referral credit and loyalty points that add up.

"Book twice, and the third one is on your points."

How the work flows · 8 steps

1 Attract

Set monthly spend by channel from the budget model. Run search, Meta, YouTube and app-install campaigns by destination

Performance marketing · Always on; pacing checked daily
gives: App install or sign-up

2 Welcome & profile

Day 0 welcome email and push. Preference quiz: destinations, budget, travel group, language

CRM & lifecycle · First message within 5 min
gives: Opted-in, profiled user

3 Engage & nudge

Personal deals and destination content from profile. Abandoned search and cart reminders

◆ Booked? No → keep nudging, max 3

CRM & lifecycle · Nudge at 24 h, 72 h, 7 days
gives: Return visit, booking

4 Book & confirm

One message with itinerary, GST invoice and support contact. Add trip to in-app wallet

Product & customer service · Confirmation within 1 min
gives: Confirmed booking

5 Prepare the trip

Check-in details, directions, weather. Offer experiences from Destination & Merchant

CRM & lifecycle · T-7 and T-1
gives: Add-ons booked, fewer calls

6 Support during trip

Live WhatsApp and in-app chat. Hand in-trip offers to Destination & Merchant

Product & customer service · Reply within 15 min, 24/7
gives: Issues solved on the trip

7 Review & share

Rating and review request. Invite photos and short video for the in-app feed

Community & social · Reply to reviews within 48 h
gives: Reviews, UGC, referrals

8 Book again

Credit loyalty points. Next-trip ideas from past trip

CRM & lifecycle · Hand to Lifecycle at T+30
gives: Repeat booking

Lead flow · how people move through



How we measure it

Cost per install (CPI)

What one app install from paid ads costs. The first check on whether ad money is buying people at a sensible price.

$$\text{Paid media spend} \div \text{Installs from paid campaigns}$$

Weekly · Performance marketing · lower is better

Sign-up rate

The share of people who install the app and then create an account. A low rate means onboarding asks too much too early.

$$\text{Sign-ups} \div \text{Installs} \times 100$$

Weekly · Product · higher is better

Opt-in rate

The share of new users who allow WhatsApp or push messages. Without opt-in, the CRM steps cannot reach them.

$$\text{Users opted into WhatsApp or push} \div \text{Sign-ups} \times 100$$

Weekly · CRM · higher is better

30-day booking conversion

Of the people who signed up in a month, how many booked within 30 days. The main test of whether the Welcome and Engage steps work.

$$\text{First bookings within 30 days of sign-up} \div \text{Sign-ups in the same month (cohort)} \times 100$$

Monthly · CRM · higher is better

Blended CAC

The full cost to win one paying customer: all marketing spend, including creators and content, divided by new customers. The same measure as cost per booking in the budget engine.

$$\text{Total marketing spend} \div \text{New booking customers}$$

Monthly · Marketing lead · lower is better

Average booking value

The average value of one booking. Multiplied by completed bookings it gives the north star.

$$\text{Gross booking value (GBV)} \div \text{Number of bookings}$$

Monthly · Marketing lead · higher is better

Review rate

The share of completed trips that leave a review. Reviews build trust for the next traveller and supply content for the feed.

$$\text{Reviews received} \div \text{Completed trips} \times 100$$

Monthly · Community & social · higher is better

Referral share

How much of the business comes from guests recommending Vacario. Referral bookings have almost no media cost.

$$\text{Bookings from referral links or credits} \div \text{All bookings} \times 100$$

Monthly · CRM · higher is better

12-month repeat rate

The share of customers who booked two or more times in the last 12 months. The cheapest booking is from a past guest.

$$\text{Customers with 2+ bookings in 12 months} \div \text{Customers who booked in the same 12 months} \times 100$$

Quarterly · CRM · higher is better

💡 Try this on Monday

1. Every campaign link carries tracking tags, so each booking can be traced to its source.
2. No more than one marketing message a day per person across all touchpoints.
3. WhatsApp and SMS go only to people who have opted in.
4. Service messages (confirmation, trip details) always go out, even to people who opted out of marketing.

Watch out for

- **Installs rise but bookings do not:** Check sign-up rate and 30-day conversion before adding ad spend.
- **Guests stop opening messages:** Cut frequency and base content on the preference quiz, not generic deals.
- **Bad reviews after a stay:** Send to Supply the same day; fix the property before promoting it again.

CHANNEL 02 · FROM THE PLAN

Supply Communications

A B2B acquisition and relationship-management channel. Its messaging differs from consumer advertising: commission, reach, payout reliability and ease of listing.

Each month the supply lead compares what travellers search for with what Vacario can sell and names the gaps. Business development contacts suitable owners, hotels and managers and qualifies them. Finance and legal agree terms and sign. Supply operations builds and checks the listing, makes a test booking and switches it on. From then on, operations keeps prices and availability accurate every day, and an account manager sends monthly results and meets the best partners each quarter to add more inventory.

Property owners Property managers Hotels Travel suppliers

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Search data shows many travellers looking for Munnar tea-estate stays but few listings (1). BD calls ten estates and qualifies four (2). Three sign on the standard commission, with GST documents collected (3). Operations photographs one estate, connects its channel manager and loads rates (4), then makes a test booking before switching it on (5). A sync error one weekend is fixed the same day (6). At month end the owner gets a statement showing 14 bookings and agrees to list a second cottage (7).

What we say · tone: businesslike, specific, respectful of the owner's time

New demand

Travellers from across India looking for stays like yours.

"Fill your quiet weeks with guests who want exactly what you offer."

Fair and fast

Clear commission, no hidden fees, payouts on the agreed date.

"Know what you earn, and get it on time."

Easy

Listing help, channel-manager and API connections, one account manager.

"We set it up with you, and one person looks after you."

How the work flows · 7 steps

1 Target the gaps

Compare search demand with live inventory by destination.
Rank property types and price bands with gaps

Supply lead · List ready by day 5 of month
gives: Prioritised target list

2 Reach out

Pitch: new Indian demand, commission, payout speed, marketing support. Calls, email, LinkedIn, hotel associations, trade fairs

◆ Qualified? No → nurture list, retry in 90 days

Business development · First contact within 5 working days
gives: Qualified lead

3 Agree terms & contract

Commission, cancellation policy, rate parity. Collect registration, PAN and GST documents

Finance & legal · Contract in 10 working days
gives: Signed supplier

4 Onboard the listing

Photos, descriptions, amenities. Connect channel manager or API

Supply operations · Listing built in 7 days
gives: Listing ready for QA

5 QA & go live

Check content, prices and policies. Make a test booking end to end

◆ Passed QA? No → back to onboarding

Supply operations · QA within 2 days
gives: Live, bookable inventory

6 Keep it accurate

Monitor sync errors and stale calendars. Check rate parity against other sites

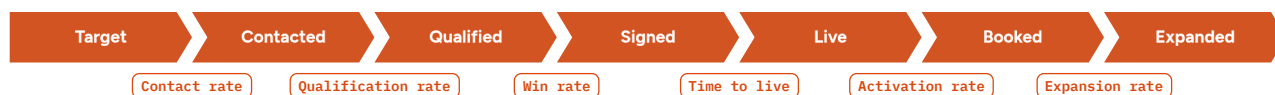
Supply operations · Sync errors fixed same day
gives: Accurate availability and price

7 Report & grow

Monthly performance statement per partner. Quarterly review with top partners

Account management · Statement by day 5; QBR each quarter
gives: More inventory from partners

Lead flow · how people move through



How we measure it

Pipeline coverage

Whether there are enough good leads to hit next month's signing target.

Qualified leads in the pipeline ÷ Monthly signing target

Weekly · Business development · higher is better

Win rate

The share of qualified leads that sign. Shows whether the pitch and terms work.

Suppliers signed ÷ Qualified leads × 100

Monthly · Business development · higher is better

Time to live

How long it takes from a signed contract to a bookable listing. Every day in between is inventory Vacario paid to win but cannot sell.

Median of (go-live date – contract date) for listings that went live this period

Weekly · Supply operations · lower is better

Live listings by destination

How much bookable inventory there is in each priority destination.

Count of listings that are live and bookable, per priority destination

Weekly · Supply lead · higher is better

Availability accuracy

How often a booking goes through at the shown price and availability. Failed bookings lose the traveller and hurt trust.

(1 – Bookings that failed on availability or price ÷ Bookings attempted) × 100

Daily · Supply operations · higher is better

Supplier cancellation rate

The share of bookings a supplier cancels. Each one strands a traveller and costs a rebooking.

Bookings cancelled by the supplier ÷ All bookings × 100

Monthly · Account management · lower is better

Rate parity

Whether Vacario shows the same or better price than other sites for the same stay.

Listings at parity or better ÷ Listings checked × 100

Weekly · Supply operations · higher is better

Bookings per live listing

How productive the average listing is. Shows whether new inventory is in places travellers want.

Bookings in the month ÷ Live listings

Monthly · Supply lead · higher is better

Supplier satisfaction

How happy partners are with Vacario, from a short quarterly survey.

Sum of scores ÷ number of responses (scale 1–10)

Quarterly · Account management · higher is better

💡 Try this on Monday

1. No listing goes live without a successful test booking.
2. Every partner has one named account manager.
3. Payouts are made on the agreed date, every time.
4. Rate parity is checked every week.

Watch out for

- **Signed partners take weeks to go live:** Track time to live per listing; chase anything over 14 days.
- **Bookings fail because rooms are not really free:** Move the partner to a channel manager or API and watch sync errors daily.
- **Partners go quiet after signing:** Send the first monthly statement even with zero bookings, with a plan to change that.

CHANNEL 03 · FROM THE PLAN

Creator Communications

The creator is not only an advertising medium. Creators become part of the Vacario distribution system, with their own links, content and bookings.

Each quarter the team finds creators who match target travellers by niche, region and language, and invites the best into the programme on one of three tiers. Onboarding gives them a kit, a tracking link and code, and the disclosure rules. For a campaign, the content lead briefs the trip and books the stay through Supply. Drafts are checked before posting. Social reshares the posts and boosts the best as paid ads. Finance pays monthly from the attribution report, and the strongest creators move to long-term ambassador deals.

Influencers · Creators · Campus ambassadors

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The team finds a Telugu travel creator with 80,000 engaged followers in Andhra Pradesh and Telangana (1) and signs her on the micro tier with commission per booking (2). She gets her link, the code VAC-ANU and the disclosure rules (3). The brief is a monsoon weekend in Araku Valley, booked through a supply partner (4). Her draft is approved in a day (5). The Reel posts, is reshared and boosted (6). Her code brings 22 bookings and she is paid on the 10th (7). After two strong quarters she becomes an ambassador (8).

What we say · tone: friendly, collaborative, clear about money and rules

Earn

Commission on every booking you drive, plus fees and hosted trips.

"Your audience books, you earn."

Stories

Stays and destinations worth filming, with the details sorted.

"We handle the trip. You tell the story."

Grow

Tiers, ambassador deals and early access to launches.

"The best creators help shape where we go next."

How the work flows · 8 steps

1 Scout

Search by travel niche, region and language (Telugu, Hindi, Tamil, English). Check audience location and real engagement

Creator partnerships · Shortlist in first 2 weeks of quarter
gives: Shortlist by tier

2 Recruit

Invite to the creator programme. Offer: commission per booking, hosted trip or fixed fee

◆ Signed? No → keep on watch list

Creator partnerships · Reply to interest within 48 h
gives: Signed creator

3 Onboard

Brand guidelines and tone. Unique tracking link and discount code

Creator partnerships · Kit sent within 2 days
gives: Creator ready to post

4 Brief the story

Destination, property, dates, deliverables. Content calendar and key messages

Content lead · Brief 3 weeks before travel
gives: Approved brief

5 Review content

Check brand fit, facts and prices. Check disclosure label is present

◆ Approved? No → one round of edits

Content lead · Approve within 48 h
gives: Approved content

6 Publish & amplify

Creator posts on agreed date. Reshare and add to in-app feed

Social & performance · Reshare same day
gives: Reach and clicks

7 Track & pay

Attribute bookings to link and code. Monthly statement to each creator

Finance · Pay by day 10 of next month
gives: Paid, attributed bookings

8 Grow the best

Move top performers to ambassador deals. Invite to launches and new destinations

Creator partnerships · Tier review each quarter
gives: Always-on creator network

Lead flow · how people move through



How we measure it

Active creators by tier

How many creators are actually posting, by size of audience.

Count of creators with at least one post in the last 30 days, by tier

Monthly · Creator partnerships · higher is better

On-time delivery

The share of agreed content that arrives on the agreed date.

Content delivered by the agreed date ÷ Content due × 100

Monthly · Content lead · higher is better

Approval turnaround

How fast Vacario approves creator drafts. Slow approvals delay posts and frustrate creators.

Median hours from draft received to approval

Weekly · Content lead · lower is better

Engagement rate

How strongly a creator's audience reacts to a post. A better guide to influence than follower count.

$$\frac{\text{Likes} + \text{comments} + \text{saves} + \text{shares}}{\text{Reach (unique accounts that saw the post)}} \times 100$$

Per post · Social · higher is better

Link clicks

How many people went from creator content to Vacario.

$$\frac{\text{Sum of clicks on all creator tracking links in the period}}{\text{Reach}}$$

Weekly · Social · higher is better

Attributed bookings

Bookings Vacario can trace to a creator through their link or code.

$$\frac{\text{Bookings made through a creator link (within 30 days of the click)} + \text{bookings using a creator code}}{\text{Reach}}$$

Monthly · Creator partnerships · higher is better

Cost per attributed booking

What it costs to get one booking through creators. The creator equivalent of CAC.

$$\frac{\text{Creator fees} + \text{commission} + \text{hosted trip costs}}{\text{Attributed bookings}}$$

Monthly · Creator partnerships · lower is better

Disclosure compliance

The share of paid or gifted posts with a correct disclosure label. Required under ASCI guidelines; the target is 100%.

$$\frac{\text{Paid or gifted posts with a correct label}}{\text{Paid or gifted posts}} \times 100$$

Monthly · Content lead · higher is better

Creator retention

How many creators who were active last quarter are still active this quarter.

$$\frac{\text{Creators active in both quarters}}{\text{Creators active last quarter}} \times 100$$

Quarterly · Creator partnerships · higher is better

💡 Try this on Monday

1. Every paid or gifted post carries a clear disclosure label, in line with ASCI guidelines.
2. Creators are paid on time from the monthly statement.
3. Usage rights for paid ads are agreed before content is made.
4. One review round only, so creators keep their own voice.

Watch out for

- **Big reach, no bookings:** Judge creators on cost per attributed booking, not followers.
- **Content late or off-brief:** Brief three weeks before travel; confirm deliverables in writing.
- **Posts missing the disclosure label:** Do not approve until the label is present.

CHANNEL 04 · FROM THE PLAN

Destination & Merchant Communications

Lets Vacario talk to the traveller through the whole trip, instead of disappearing once the stay or flight is booked.

For each priority destination the team maps the tourism board, attractions, restaurants and experience operators. Tourism boards are offered co-marketing and traveller insight; merchants are offered visitors who are already in town. Each offer has clear terms and a code or QR for redemption. Content builds guides and offer cards in the app. CRM puts offers in the pre-trip message and sends timely suggestions during the stay. Redemptions are recorded, partners are settled monthly and offers are refreshed before each season.

Tourism boards Attractions Restaurants Experiences

Local merchants

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Jaipur is a priority destination, so the team maps the tourism department, Amber Fort guides and ten restaurants (1). A food-walk operator and three restaurants agree to offers (2-3). Guides and offer cards go into the app (4). A family booked for November gets the food walk in their pre-trip message and a restaurant offer on arrival evening (5). They scan the QR at dinner (6). The restaurant is paid its commission on the 10th (7), and offers are refreshed for winter (8).

What we say · tone: local, practical, partnership-minded

Reach

Visitors already in your town, at the moment they are choosing what to do.

"Guests nearby, looking for tonight's plan."

Results

Every redemption counted and visible to you.

"You see the same numbers we do."

Partnership

Co-marketing with a platform growing across India.

"Grow with the next generation of travel."

How the work flows · 8 steps

1 Map the destination

Tourism board and state tourism department. Top attractions, restaurants, experience operators

Destination partnerships · Map in 2 weeks
gives: Destination partner map

2 Approach partners

Tourism boards: co-marketing and traveller insight. Merchants: reach visitors already in town

Destination partnerships · All tier-1 partners contacted in 30 days
gives: Interested partners

3 Agree the offer

Offer, validity dates, limits. Redemption by code or QR

◆ Terms agreed? No → revise offer

Destination partnerships · Offer signed in 10 days
gives: Signed offer

4 Build the content

Destination guide and itineraries. Offer cards tagged by place and season

Content · Live in 5 days
gives: Offers live in app

5 Deliver pre-trip & in-trip

Suggest offers in pre-trip message. Timely offer while in destination

CRM · Pre-trip at T-3; in-trip daily max 1
gives: Offer views and saves

6 Redeem & record

Record each redemption. Same number visible to merchant and Vacario

Product · Real time
gives: Logged redemptions

7 Settle & report

Monthly commission settlement. Campaign report for tourism boards

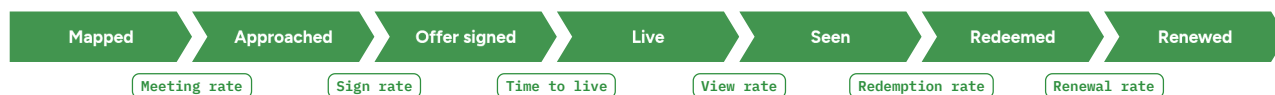
Finance · Settle by day 10
gives: Paid partners, renewal case

8 Refresh by season

Festive season (Oct–Nov), winter holidays, summer, monsoon getaways. Renew best offers, drop weak ones

Destination partnerships · 6 weeks before each season
gives: Current offers every season

Lead flow · how people move through



How we measure it

Destination coverage

How many priority destinations have enough local partners to fill a trip with offers.

$\text{Priority destinations with 5+ live partners} \div \text{Priority destinations} \times 100$

Monthly · Destination partnerships · higher is better

Active offers

How many offers a traveller can use in each destination.

$\text{Count of offers live in the app, per destination}$

Weekly · Content · higher is better

In-trip view rate

The share of travellers in a destination who open at least one offer.

$\text{Travellers who viewed an offer} \div \text{Travellers in the destination} \times 100$

Weekly · CRM · higher is better

Redemption rate

The share of travellers in a destination who use an offer.

$$\text{Offer redemptions} \div \text{Travellers in the destination} \times 100$$

Monthly · Destination partnerships · higher is better

Ancillary revenue per trip

The extra revenue earned on each trip beyond the stay.

$$\text{Commission} + \text{experience revenue} \div \text{Completed trips}$$

Monthly · Destination partnerships · higher is better

Settlement on time

The share of partners paid by the 10th of the following month.

$$\text{Partners paid by day 10} \div \text{Partners due payment} \times 100$$

Monthly · Finance · higher is better

Sponsorship revenue

Money from tourism boards and sponsors for campaigns and placement.

$$\text{Sum of tourism board, co-marketing and sponsor fees recognised in the period}$$

Quarterly · Destination partnerships · higher is better

Partner renewal rate

The share of destination partners who renew for the next season.

$$\text{Partners who renewed} \div \text{Partners up for renewal} \times 100$$

Seasonal · Destination partnerships · higher is better

💡 Try this on Monday

1. At most one in-trip offer message a day.
2. Every offer has an end date and a redemption method before it goes live.
3. Merchants see the same redemption count Vacario sees.
4. Tourism boards get a report within two weeks of each campaign.

Watch out for

- **Offers go unused:** Send them at the right moment (arrival day, near the place) and drop weak ones.
- **Merchants dispute numbers:** Use QR redemption logged in real time and visible to both sides.
- **Stale offers after the season:** Refresh six weeks before each season.

CHANNEL 05 · FROM THE PLAN

Corporate Communications

The message changes from “book your next trip” to the corporate story: what Vacario is building, growth, technology, partnerships, milestones and market expansion.

Leadership approves one message house every six months. Communications keeps a calendar of milestones and prepares a pack for each: press release, fact sheet, investor note, partner brief, internal note and Q&A. Finance checks the numbers, legal checks the claims and the CEO signs off. Employees are briefed first; then each audience hears the news through its own route on the same day. One spokesperson handles questions, and results are logged.

Investors Media Governments Strategic partners Employees

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Vacario signs a co-marketing agreement with a state tourism department, which fits the “India first” message (1). It goes on the calendar for the second week of the month (2). The pack is drafted (3); finance checks the numbers, legal approves the department’s name and the CEO signs off (4). Staff in Canada, India and the Philippines are briefed that morning (5). The release goes to media, investors and partners (6). The CEO takes two interview requests (7), and the coverage report is filed a week later (8).

What we say · tone: clear, factual, confident, never inflated

What we’re building

The next generation of travel, launching in India before any other country.

“Built for how India travels next.”

Growth and proof

Milestones, partnerships and numbers checked by finance.

“Every number we share is one we can stand behind.”

Partnership

Working with governments, tourism bodies and industry.

“Good for travellers, hosts and local economies.”

How the work flows · 8 steps

1 Set the story

What Vacario is building and why India first. Technology, growth, partnerships

CEO & leadership · Reviewed every 6 months
gives: Approved message house

2 Plan milestones

Launches, city expansion, partnerships. Funding, awards, hires

Communications · Updated monthly
gives: Announcement calendar

3 Prepare materials

Press release and fact sheet.
Investor note and partner brief
Communications · Pack ready 10 days before
gives: Draft pack

4 Check & approve

Finance checks every number.
Legal checks claims and partner names

◆ Approved? No → revise pack

Finance & legal · Sign-off in 3 working days
gives: Approved pack

5 Tell employees first

Brief Canada, India and Philippines teams. Share the Q&A
CEO & leadership · At least 2 h before release
gives: Team briefed

6 Release by audience

Investors: update email. Media: release, interviews

Communications · Same day, all audiences
gives: Announcement out

7 Answer questions

One named spokesperson. Use the prepared Q&A

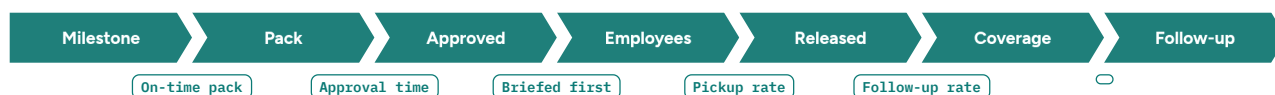
Communications · Media reply within 4 h
gives: Consistent answers

8 Measure & file

Coverage and message pull-through. Investor and partner responses

Communications · Report in 7 days
gives: Lessons for next time

Lead flow · how people move through



How we measure it

Milestones on schedule

Whether announcements go out on the planned date.

$\text{Announcements made on the planned date} \div \text{Announcements planned} \times 100$

Monthly · Communications · higher is better

Media mentions

How often Vacario appears in the media.

Count of articles, broadcasts and posts naming Vacario, from the coverage log

Monthly · Communications · higher is better

Tier-1 coverage share

The share of coverage in national business and travel media.

$\text{Mentions in tier-1 media} \div \text{All mentions} \times 100$

Monthly · Communications · higher is better

Message pull-through

Whether coverage carries Vacario's own key messages.

$$\text{Coverage carrying at least one key message} \div \text{All coverage} \times 100$$

Per release · Communications · higher is better

Investor update on time

Whether investors get their update on the agreed date. Target 100%.

$$\text{Updates sent by the agreed date} \div \text{Updates due} \times 100$$

Monthly · CEO · higher is better

Investor meetings

Interest the updates and releases create among investors.

$$\text{Count of investor meetings or calls that came from an update or release}$$

Quarterly · CEO · higher is better

Government and tourism MoUs

Formal partnerships with government and tourism bodies.

$$\text{Count of MoUs or formal partnerships signed with government or tourism bodies}$$

Quarterly · CEO · higher is better

Employees briefed first

Whether staff heard the news before the public. Target 100%.

$$\text{Releases with a staff briefing beforehand} \div \text{Releases} \times 100$$

Per release · CEO · higher is better

💡 Try this on Monday

1. Employees hear news before anyone outside.
2. Finance checks every number before release.
3. Only the named spokesperson speaks to media.
4. Partner names are used only with written approval.

Watch out for

- **Different people quote different numbers:** The fact sheet is the only source; log every figure released.
- **Staff learn news from social media:** Hold the release until the internal briefing has gone out.
- **Announcements bunch up or slip:** Update the milestone calendar monthly; plan one major story a month.

CHANNEL 06 · FROM THE PLAN

Lifecycle Communications

Directly tied to guest and partner retention. Communication should not stop once someone joins, spends, sells or sponsors. This is where Vacario should shine.

Guests, suppliers, creators and merchants each follow the same five stages on their own track. They are welcomed and pointed to one first action. Anyone without a first result in 14 days gets reminders, then a personal call. Each month they receive something useful. Milestones are recognised and rewarded. Feedback is collected at key moments and detractors are called back. Anyone going quiet is flagged and contacted with a personal offer or a renewal conversation.

Guests Suppliers Creators Merchants & sponsors

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A new homestay owner signs up and gets a welcome with one task: upload photos **(Join)**. By day 10 the listing is not live, so the account manager calls and finishes it with them **(Activate)**. Each month they get a statement with bookings and reviews **(Engage)**. At 100 nights sold they get a top-partner badge and featured placement **(Reward)**. When availability drops in the off-season they are flagged and invited into a monsoon promotion **(Retain)**.

What we say · tone: personal, helpful, never pushy

Welcome

Help every new member or partner to a first result.

"Here's one thing to do first."

Value

Something useful every month, never just a sale.

"Here's what's new for you."

Recognition

Notice milestones and reward loyalty.

"Five trips with us. Thank you."

How the work flows · 7 steps

1 Welcome

One welcome track per audience.
One clear next action

CRM (guests) · Same day
gives: First action started

2 Activate

Guest: first booking. Supplier:
listing live; creator: first post

◆ Activated? No → personal call

Account managers (partners) ·
Reminder day 3, call day 10
gives: Activated member or
partner

3 Give value monthly

Guests: trip ideas and member
prices. Partners: performance
statement

Account managers (partners) ·
By day 5 of month
gives: Ongoing engagement

4 Mark milestones

First trip, 5th booking. 100th
night sold, top-partner badge

CRM (guests) · Within 24 h of
milestone
gives: Loyalty

5 Ask for feedback

Short NPS question. Call every
detractor

Customer service & insight ·
Close detractor loop in 72 h
gives: Satisfaction score and
fixes

6 Spot risk early

Guest: no visit in 60 days.
Supplier: falling availability

Customer service & insight ·
Weekly at-risk list
gives: At-risk list

7 Win back or renew

Personal offer or call. Renewal
review for sponsors

Account managers (partners) ·
Contact within 7 days of flag
gives: Retained member or
partner

Lead flow · how people move through



How we measure it

Activation rate

The share of new guests or partners who reach their first result within 14 days: first booking, listing live, first post or first redemption.

**Reached first result within 14 days
÷ Joined in the same period × 100**

Weekly · CRM / account managers · higher is better

Time to first value

How long it takes a new member or partner to get their first result.

**Median days from joining to first
result**

Monthly · CRM / account managers · lower is better

90-day retention

The share of people who joined in a month and are still active 90 days later.

**Still active at day 90 ÷ Joined in
the same month (cohort) × 100**

Monthly · CRM · higher is better

Repeat booking rate

The share of guests with two or more bookings in 12 months. The same measure as Consumer's 12-month repeat rate, owned jointly.

$$\text{Guests with 2+ bookings in 12 months} \div \text{Guests who booked in the same 12 months} \times 100$$

Quarterly · CRM · higher is better

Partner churn

The share of suppliers or creators who left during the period.

$$\text{Partners lost in the period} \div \text{Partners active at the start of the period} \times 100$$

Quarterly · Account managers · lower is better

Sponsor renewal rate

The share of sponsors who renew.

$$\text{Sponsors who renewed} \div \text{Sponsors up for renewal} \times 100$$

Quarterly · Account managers · higher is better

NPS by audience

How likely people are to recommend Vacario, on a 0–10 scale. Promoters answer 9–10, detractors 0–6.

$$\% \text{ promoters (9–10)} - \% \text{ detractors (0–6)}$$

Monthly · Customer service & insight · higher is better

Win-back rate

The share of at-risk members who come back after being contacted.

$$\text{At-risk members who returned within 30 days} \div \text{At-risk members contacted} \times 100$$

Monthly · CRM · higher is better

Loyalty share

The share of bookings made by loyalty members.

$$\text{Bookings by loyalty members} \div \text{All bookings} \times 100$$

Monthly · CRM · higher is better

💡 Try this on Monday

1. One track per audience; nobody gets another audience's messages.
2. Every message has one clear next action.
3. Detractors are contacted within 72 hours.
4. Renewals start 60 days before the end date.

Watch out for

- **Many join, few activate:** Shorten the path to the first result and call at day 10.
- **Partners leave without warning:** Act on early signs (falling availability, no posts) from the weekly at-risk list.
- **Too many messages:** Cap marketing messages; let triggered messages replace scheduled ones.

CHANNEL 07 · FROM THE PLAN

Internal Communications

The systems and routines that keep the organisation aligned, informed, accountable and moving quickly across Canada, India, technology, operations, marketing and leadership.

Leadership sets priorities each month and records decisions. Finance turns them into approved budgets. Each week the management review checks progress against KPIs and assigns actions, and each function plans its week. Because the regions are hours apart, each ends its day with a handoff note so work continues overnight. Operations runs daily check-ins where needed. Finance publishes one dashboard every Monday. Everything is filed in the knowledge base, and incidents follow a set escalation path.

LeadershipCanadaIndiaPhilippinesAll functions

What we say · tone: direct, brief, written down

One source of truth

One dashboard, one knowledge base, one decision log.

"If it isn't written down, it wasn't decided."

Clear paths

Everyone knows who decides, who acts and who is told.

"Every action has one owner and a date."

Across time zones

Canada, India and the Philippines hand over every day.

"Nothing waits overnight."

How the work flows · 9 steps

1 Set strategy & decisions

Priorities, major decisions, approvals. Investor and shareholder matters

Executive team · First week of month
gives: Monthly priorities

2 Budgets & approvals

Budget per function against the model. Cash need and forecast

Finance · Approvals within 3 working days
gives: Approved function plans

3 Weekly management review

Each head: progress, blockers, KPIs. Decisions and owners recorded

Executive team · Monday, 45 min
gives: Actions with owners

4 Weekly functional meetings

Tech & product, supply, marketing & social. Finance, customer service, BD

Function heads · Tuesday–Wednesday
gives: Team work plans

5 Time-zone handoff

Handoff note: done, open, needs decision. Overlap call when needed

Region leads · Every working day
gives: No waiting overnight

6 Daily check-ins

Priorities and staffing. Customer-service and vendor issues

Operations · 15 min where required
gives: Issues assigned

7 Performance reporting

Users, bookings, engagement, conversion. Inventory, creator activity, revenue

Finance · Dashboard every Monday
gives: One set of numbers

8 Knowledge base

Contracts, decks, brand assets, specs. SOPs, research, meeting notes

Operations · Notes filed within 24 h
gives: One source of truth

9 Crisis & escalation

Detect, log, set severity. Escalate, contain, communicate

◆ SEV 1? Yes → CEO at once

Operations · SEV 1 acknowledged in 15 min
gives: Contained, logged incident

A WORKED EXAMPLE

At the monthly review, leadership decides to open Goa inventory first (1). Finance approves the extra supply budget in two days (2). Monday's management review gives the Goa target to the supply lead (3), and the supply team plans its week (4). India's evening handoff note tells Canada which contracts need sign-off (5). A payments outage at 2 am IST is logged as SEV 1 and the CEO is alerted within 15 minutes (9). Monday's dashboard shows Goa listings rising (7), and the decision and post-mortem are filed (8).

From strategy to execution



How we measure it

Decision log completeness

Whether decisions made in reviews are written down.

$\text{Decisions recorded in the decision log} \div \text{Decisions made in reviews} \times 100$

Monthly · Executive team · higher is better

Action close rate

The share of actions finished by their due date.

$\text{Actions closed by the due date} \div \text{Actions due} \times 100$

Weekly · Function heads · higher is better

Spend approval turnaround

How fast spend requests are approved.

$\text{Median working days from request to approval}$

Monthly · Finance · lower is better

Dashboard on time

Whether the weekly dashboard comes out by Monday. Target 100%.

$\text{Weeks the dashboard was published by Monday} \div \text{Weeks in the period} \times 100$

Monthly · Finance · higher is better

Handoff compliance

Whether each region sends its end-of-day handoff note.

$\text{Handoff notes sent} \div \text{Region working days (3 regions} \times \text{working days)} \times 100$

Weekly · Region leads · higher is better

SEV 1 response time

How fast a critical incident is acknowledged by its owner. Target 15 minutes or less.

$\text{Minutes from detection to acknowledgement, for each SEV 1 incident}$

Per incident · Operations · lower is better

Time to resolve

How long incidents take to fix, by severity.

$\text{Median hours from detection to resolution, per severity level}$

Monthly · Operations · lower is better

Post-mortems filed

Whether lessons from serious incidents are written down.

$\text{SEV 1-2 incidents with a post-mortem within 5 working days} \div \text{SEV 1-2 incidents} \times 100$

Monthly · Operations · higher is better

SOP freshness

Whether procedures are kept up to date.

$\text{SOPs reviewed in the last 6 months} \div \text{All SOPs} \times 100$

Quarterly · Operations · higher is better

🔍 Try this on Monday

1. If a decision is not in the decision log, it has not been made.
2. Every action has one owner and a due date.
3. One dashboard; nobody presents their own version of the numbers.
4. SEV 1 incidents reach the CEO at once, at any hour.

Watch out for

- **Work waits overnight between regions:** Handoff note every working day, with an owner for each open item.
- **Meetings end without decisions:** Close every meeting by reading back decisions and owners.
- **Files scattered across inboxes:** Nothing counts as shared until it is in the knowledge base.

Workflows that cross every channel



Nine workflows cover work that belongs to **no single channel**: leads, campaigns, referrals, reviews, support, consent, promotions, business trips and MICE.

Each is a short chain of steps, each step with one owner and a time limit. Open one to see the chain, its yes/no checkpoints and how we measure it.

W1

Lead management & routing

The plan runs several lead flows at once: travellers who enquire, suppliers, creators, merchants, partners and investors.

Without one way to capture, score and route them, leads wait, get lost or get two replies. This workflow gives every lead one owner and a response time.

Capture → Clean and match → Score and classify ◆ Qualified? → Route to an owner → First response → Follow up →

Convert or close → Report and learn

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER	TIME ALLOWED
Capture	Every enquiry becomes one lead record, whatever the source: web form, WhatsApp, call, event, email or partner referral. Source and campaign are tagged.	Marketing operations	Automatic; manual entries same day
Clean and match	Remove duplicates and link to any existing member, supplier or partner record so nobody is contacted twice.	Marketing operations	Within 1 hour
Score and classify	B2C: hot (dates and budget given), warm, cold. B2B: supplier, creator, merchant, partner or investor.	Marketing operations	Within 1 hour
Route to an owner	Hot B2C leads to the travel desk; B2B leads to the named BD owner for that type; cold leads to CRM nurture.	Travel desk (B2C)	Owner assigned within 1 hour
First response	Reply personally with something useful: options, a price, a call slot.	Travel desk (B2C)	Hot B2C: 15 min in working hours · B2B: 1 working day
Follow up	Three touches over seven days, each adding value (a stay idea, a case study, an answer). Stop if they say no.	Business development (B2B)	Day 1, 3 and 7
Convert or close	Won leads move to the right workflow (booking, supplier onboarding, creator onboarding). Lost leads are closed with a reason.	Business development (B2B)	Within 30 days of capture
Report and learn	Weekly lead funnel by source and owner; reasons for losses feed campaigns and pitches.	CRM	Every Monday

Measured by:

Lead response time (Median minutes (B2C) or hours (B2B) from capture to first reply) · Owner assigned within 1 hour (Leads with an owner within 1 h ÷ leads captured × 100) · Lead-to-qualified rate (Qualified leads ÷ leads captured × 100) · Qualified-to-won rate (Won ÷ qualified leads closed × 100) · Cost per qualified lead (Spend on lead generation ÷ qualified leads)

Benchmark:

Corporate OTAs (myBiz, Cleartrip's Out of Office) route business enquiries to dedicated teams; Vacario routes every lead to one owner.

W2

Campaign launch

Campaigns cross channels: an offer needs creative, paid media, CRM, creators, sometimes suppliers and legal checks.

This workflow makes every campaign start from one brief and end with a written result.

Brief

 →

Plan channels

 →

Make creative

 →

Check and approve Approved?

 →

Set up tracking

 →

Launch and check

 →

Optimise

→

Wrap up

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER	TIME ALLOWED
Brief	One page: goal, audience, offer, budget, dates, the KPI that decides success and its target.	Marketing lead	6 weeks before launch
Plan channels	Choose channels and the calendar slot with Lifecycle so no audience is over-messed.	Marketing lead	5 weeks before
Make creative	Copy and assets for every touchpoint, in English and the chosen regional languages.	Content & creative	3 weeks before
Check and approve	Brand check, legal check of claims and terms, finance check of budget and discount cost.	Finance & legal	3 working days
Set up tracking	Campaign tags, promo codes, dashboard view and a baseline to compare against.	Analytics	1 week before
Launch and check	Go live, test every link and code, confirm the first results are recording.	Performance & CRM	Launch day
Optimise	Move budget to what works, pause what does not, refresh creative that tires.	Performance & CRM	Weekly
Wrap up	Results against the target, what we learned, and what to do next time, filed in the knowledge base.	Analytics	2 weeks after end

Measured by: Campaigns launched on time $(\text{On-time launches} \div \text{campaigns planned} \times 100)$ · Return on ad spend $(\text{Gross booking value from the campaign} \div \text{campaign spend})$ · Cost per booking vs plan $(\text{Actual cost per booking} \div \text{planned cost per booking})$ · Reports filed $(\text{Campaigns with a wrap-up report} \div \text{campaigns ended} \times 100)$

Benchmark: Large OTAs run sale events on a calendar; Vacario books every campaign into the Lifecycle calendar first.

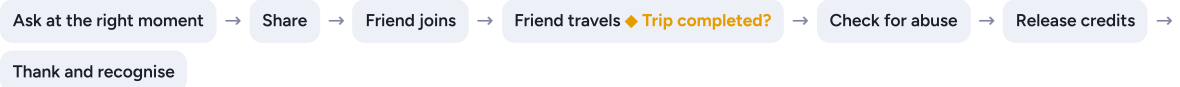
W3

Referral programme

Referral bookings cost almost nothing in media and come with trust built in.



The plan names referral programmes as a consumer channel; this workflow defines when to ask, when to pay out and how to stop abuse.



STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER	TIME ALLOWED
Ask at the right moment	Invite after a 4–5 star review, after a milestone, or when the guest shares a trip.	CRM	Same day as the trigger
Share	The guest shares a personal link or code by WhatsApp or social.	Guest	Guest's choice
Friend joins	The friend signs up with the link; a welcome credit is reserved for both.	Product	Instant
Friend travels	Credit becomes payable only after the friend's first trip is completed, which prevents cancellation abuse.	Product	At check-out
Check for abuse	Same device, payment card or address, or self-referral, blocks the credit.	Finance	Within 2 days
Release credits	Credit both wallets and tell both people.	Finance	Within 3 days of check-out
Thank and recognise	Top referrers are thanked, rewarded and invited to become advocates.	CRM	Monthly

Measured by: Invite rate $(\text{Guests who shared a link} \div \text{guests invited} \times 100)$ · Referral sign-ups $(\text{Sign-ups through referral links})$ · Referral share $(\text{Referral bookings} \div \text{all bookings} \times 100)$ · Cost per referral booking $(\text{Referral credits paid} \div \text{referral bookings})$ · Referral abuse rate $(\text{Blocked referrals} \div \text{referrals checked} \times 100)$

Benchmark: Credits pay only after the friend's first completed trip, the safeguard most travel referral schemes use against cancellation abuse.

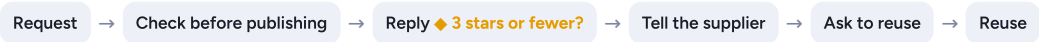
W4

Reviews and user photos & videos (UGC)

Reviews build trust for the next traveller, show suppliers what to fix and supply content for the feed and ads.



This workflow covers collecting, checking, answering and reusing them fairly.



STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER	TIME ALLOWED
Request	One-tap rating the day after check-out, then an invite to add photos or video.	CRM	C+1 and C+7
Check before publishing	Remove personal data and abuse. Never edit the meaning or hide a fair negative review.	Community & social	Within 24 hours
Reply	Reply to every review. Three stars or fewer get a personal reply and a support ticket.	Community & social	Within 48 hours
Tell the supplier	Negative issues go to the supplier within a day; a weekly digest covers everything else.	Supply	24 hours / weekly
Ask to reuse	Ask permission before using a guest's photo or video in marketing, and credit them.	Community & social	Before any reuse
Reuse	Best content goes to the in-app feed, social and ads.	Community & social	Weekly

Measured by: Review rate $(\text{Reviews} \div \text{completed trips} \times 100)$ · Average rating $(\text{Sum of ratings} \div \text{number of ratings})$ · Review reply time $(\text{Median hours from publish to reply})$ · Negative reviews resolved $(\text{Negative reviews with a closed support ticket} \div \text{negative reviews} \times 100)$ · UGC pieces reused $(\text{Guest photos and videos used with permission})$

Benchmark: Booking.com accepts reviews only from verified guests; Airbnb reviews are double-blind for 14 days.

W5

Customer support & service recovery

The plan promises communication through the whole trip.

When something goes wrong, how fast and how fairly Vacario fixes it decides whether the guest comes back. This workflow sets response times, limits for compensation and the loop back to suppliers.

Contact

 →

Log and sort ♦ Safety or stranded?

 →

First response

 →

Fix with the supplier

 →

Make it right

 →

Close and check

 →

Stop it happening again

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER	TIME ALLOWED
Contact	By WhatsApp, in-app chat, phone or email. One number and one chat everywhere.	Guest	24/7
Log and sort	Every contact is a ticket with a type: booking change, payment, stay problem, safety.	Customer service	Immediately
First response	A person replies, confirms they understand and says what happens next.	Customer service	In-trip: 15 min · otherwise 4 h
Fix with the supplier	Call the supplier, find another room or stay, or arrange what is needed.	Supply	In-trip: within 2 h
Make it right	Refund, credit or upgrade within set limits: the agent up to a set amount, the team lead above it, finance above that.	Finance	Same day
Close and check	Close only when the guest confirms; send a short satisfaction question.	Customer service	Within 24 h of fix
Stop it happening again	Weekly review of causes; repeat supplier issues go to Supply's account manager.	Supply	Weekly

Measured by: First response time (Median minutes from contact to first human reply) · Resolution time (Median hours from contact to closed ticket) · First-contact resolution (Tickets solved in one contact ÷ tickets × 100) · Customer satisfaction (CSAT) (Satisfied answers ÷ all answers × 100) · Refunds and credits as % of GBV (Refunds + credits ÷ gross booking value × 100)

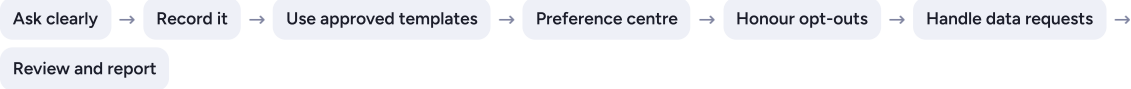
Benchmark: Airbnb AirCover sets the expectation: rebook or refund when check-in fails.

W6

Consent & data privacy

CRM, WhatsApp, SMS and push only work with permission, and India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 sets rules for collecting and using personal data. ✕

This workflow makes consent clear, recorded and easy to withdraw, which also keeps messages welcome.



STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER	TIME ALLOWED
Ask clearly	A plain notice for each purpose (email, WhatsApp, SMS, push marketing), in English and the user's language. No pre-ticked boxes.	Product	At sign-up and in settings
Record it	Store what was agreed, when, where and the wording version.	Product	Instantly
Use approved templates	SMS through registered DLT headers and templates; WhatsApp through approved message templates.	CRM	Before any send
Preference centre	Change or withdraw consent at any time, as easily as it was given.	Product	Always available
Honour opt-outs	Stop marketing on that touchpoint at once; confirm to the user.	CRM	Within 24 hours
Handle data requests	Access, correction and erasure requests are logged and answered.	Customer service	Within 30 days (proposed)
Review and report	Quarterly review of notices, vendors and records; any breach follows the SEV 1 path and the Act's notification duties.	Legal & data protection	Quarterly

Measured by: Opt-in rate $(\text{Users opted in (per touchpoint)} \div \text{sign-ups} \times 100)$ · Opt-outs honoured in 24 hours $(\text{Opt-outs applied within 24 h} \div \text{opt-outs} \times 100)$ · Data requests on time $(\text{Requests closed within the deadline} \div \text{requests} \times 100)$ · Messages on approved templates $(\text{Sends using approved templates} \div \text{sends} \times 100)$

Benchmark: Indian OTAs send booking messages on WhatsApp and SMS; marketing needs separate, recorded consent.

W7

Promotions & offer approval

Discounts can buy bookings or simply give away margin.

This workflow makes every promotion prove its cost per extra booking, agree who pays, and follow approval limits.

Propose

 →

Check the margin

 →

Agree co-funding

 →

Approve by limit ♦ Within limit?

 →

Build codes and terms

 →

Launch and watch

→ Evaluate

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER	TIME ALLOWED
Propose	Goal, audience, offer, dates, expected extra bookings and cost.	Marketing	4 weeks before
Check the margin	Cost per extra booking against contribution per booking; who funds the discount.	Finance	3 working days
Agree co-funding	Where suppliers or merchants share the cost, agree it in writing.	Supply	2 weeks before
Approve by limit	Proposed limits: up to 10% off by the marketing lead, up to 20% by finance, above that by the CEO.	Finance	2 working days
Build codes and terms	Codes, caps, expiry and plain terms and conditions.	Product	1 week before
Launch and watch	Daily check of redemptions, cost and abuse; stop early if abused.	Marketing	Daily while live
Evaluate	Extra bookings against a baseline, true cost and whether to repeat.	Finance	2 weeks after end

Measured by: Promotion booking share ($\text{Bookings using a promotion} \div \text{all bookings} \times 100$) · Discount cost as % of GBV ($\text{Discounts given} \div \text{gross booking value} \times 100$) · Cost per extra booking ($\text{Discount cost} \div \text{extra bookings over baseline}$) · Promotion abuse rate ($\text{Blocked or reversed redemptions} \div \text{redemptions} \times 100$)

Benchmark: EaseMyTrip's no-convenience-fee promise shows a simple, permanent value message can beat constant discounts.

-  **Try this on Monday**
1. Pick the workflow closest to your job and check each step has a named person.
 2. Put the time limits you own on a sticky note on your screen.
 3. Next time a ball drops, find the step it dropped at and fix that step.

12

STOP 12 · OWNERS, RHYTHM, ESCALATION

Running it week to week

One accountable owner per channel, a fixed weekly rhythm across three time zones, and a clear ladder when something goes wrong.

A is accountable (one per channel, signs off), R does the work, C is asked before, I is told after.
Canada, India and the Philippines hand over every day so nothing waits overnight.



CHANNEL	CEO & LEADERSHIP	MARKETING (PERFORMANCE + CRM)	COMMUNITY, SOCIAL & CONTENT	CREATOR PARTNERSHIPS	SUPPLY & BD	DESTINATION PARTNERSHIPS	COMMUNICATIONS
01 Consumer	I	A	R	C	C	C	I
02 Supply	I	C	I	I	A	C	I
03 Creator	I	C	R	A	C	I	I
04 Destination & Merchant	I	C	R	I	C	A	I
05 Corporate	A	C	I	I	C	C	R
06 Lifecycle	I	A	R	C	R	R	I
07 Internal	A	R	R	R	R	R	C

Monday Dashboard out Management review 6 pm IST handoff	Tuesday Marketing & social Tech & product 6 pm IST handoff	Wednesday Supply pipeline Finance & approvals 6 pm IST handoff	Thursday Creator content Destination offers 6 pm IST handoff	Friday CRM plan Service & BD 6 pm IST handoff
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WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

→ Detect → Log in escalation channel → Set severity → Escalate to owner → Contain → Communicate → Resolve

→ Post-mortem & file

SEV 1
App or payments down, travellers stranded, safety incident, legal threat, press story
Answer within 15 min, any hour · to CEO + function head at once

SEV 2
Supplier overbooking, API sync failure, complaint going public on social
Answer within 1 h, working hours · to Function head, same day

SEV 3
Single customer issue, minor bug, vendor delay
Answer within Next check-in · to Team lead

💡 Try this on Monday

1. Find the one A in your channel's row. That person signs off; go to them, not the group chat.

2. If you work in India, write tonight's 6 pm handoff note: done, open, needs a decision.

3. Save the SEV 1 rule in your phone: CEO and function head at once, any hour.

13

STOP 13 · WHAT INDIA'S AND THE WORLD'S OTAS TEACH US

Borrowed from the best

We checked each flow against MakeMyTrip, Cleartrip, Yatra, EaseMyTrip, Booking.com, Expedia and Airbnb, and **kept what makes vacario different.**

Public information checked in September 2026; confirm before quoting outside the company.

BEST
OF THE OTAs

MAKEMYTRIP

Discovery and planning

Myra, MakeMyTrip's AI assistant, takes a traveller from search to a paid booking in one conversation, by voice or text, in eight languages including Telugu and Hindi. MakeMyTrip reports over 45% of its use coming from tier-2 and smaller cities.

vacario: Offer planning and booking help on WhatsApp and in-app in Telugu, Hindi and English from launch; brief regional-language creators so discovery happens in the traveller's own language.

EASEMYTRIP

Price transparency

Built its brand on "zero convenience fee" flight bookings, which earned trust and repeat use.

vacario: Show all-in prices from the first screen; no fee appears for the first time at checkout. Make it a Trust message in Consumer communications.

BOOKING.COM · EXPEDIA · MAKEMYTRIP

Loyalty

Booking.com Genius has three levels earned by number of bookings (5 and 15 within two years) and keeps them for life. Expedia's One Key pays OneKeyCash across Expedia, Hotels.com and Vrbo, with tiers based on trip elements rather than spend. MMTBLACK rewards MakeMyTrip's highest-value customers (Gold and Platinum tiers, by trips and spend in 12 months) with upgrades and priority support.

vacario: Keep tiers simple and based on trips, so occasional travellers can progress; points work like cash on the next booking; the top tier gets a priority help line. Tie tier moves to the Repeat and Advocate stages.

BOOKING.COM · AIRBNB

Reviews

Booking.com only accepts reviews from guests who booked through it and stayed or arrived. Airbnb uses double-blind reviews: host and guest each have 14 days after check-out, and neither sees the other's review until both are in or the window closes.

vacario: Verified-stay reviews only; for homestays, two-way reviews with a 14-day double-blind window; partners may reply publicly; negative reviews trigger service recovery (W4, W5).

AIRBNB

Supplier recovery

AirCover for guests promises a comparable or better stay, or a refund, if the host cancels or the guest cannot check in and the host cannot fix it; issues are reported within 72 hours.

vacario: A "Vacario Assurance" promise in the Trust pillar: a human reply in 15 minutes during a trip, a fix within 2 hours, otherwise a comparable stay or refund (W5).

AIRBNB

Supplier quality

Superhost status is reviewed every quarter on the last 12 months: at least a 4.8 rating, 10 stays (or 3 stays totalling 100 nights), 90% response rate and under 1% cancellations.

vacario: A quarterly "Top Partner" badge with published criteria (proposed: 4.6+ rating, 98%+ availability accuracy, under 1% supplier cancellations, reply within 24 hours), rewarded with better placement.

BOOKING.COM · EXPEDIA GROUP

Partner self-service

Both run partner portals where hotels manage rates, availability, reviews and payments, with help centres that explain every process.

vacario: A partner portal plus a named account manager for every partner in the first year; the monthly statement is the key message of the Supply channel.

MAKEMYTRIP MYBIZ · CLEARTRIP · EASEMYTRIP

Business trips

MakeMyTrip's myBiz offers configurable approvals, policy-based options, assured GST invoices and expense integrations. Flipkart-owned Cleartrip entered corporate travel with its "Out of Office" product. EaseMyTrip has served businesses (B2E) since 2013.

vacario: Business-trip flow: policy check first, approvals only for exceptions, GST invoice per trip and a monthly statement, 24/7 desk. Start with SMEs where speed and simplicity matter most.

YATRA MICE

Yatra bought corporate-travel company Globe All India Services in 2024, adding about 360 corporate clients and strong MICE capability, calling MICE a fast-growing segment.

vacario: Treat MICE as a planned line: start with small meetings and incentive trips delivered through Vacario's supply partners, using the MICE lifecycle and its yes/no checkpoints.

🔍 Try this on Monday

1. Book one stay on a competitor this month and screenshot every message you get.
2. Pick one idea from these stamps for your team to copy, and one to do better.

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STOP 14 · GO

Your first 13 weeks, and a quick check

Switch the system on in **three steps: foundations, launch, then scale and learn**. Then check yourself with five quick questions.



Weeks 1–4

Foundations

- Name the accountable owner for each channel and workflow
- Set up the KPI Workspace and enter the first month's numbers
- Agree targets from the budget model
- Consent notices, preference centre, SMS DLT and WhatsApp templates approved
- Message house for Corporate signed off
- Contact policy and lifecycle calendar agreed

Weeks 5–8

Launch

- Welcome, first-booking and pre-trip journeys live
- Lead management and routing live for B2C and B2B
- Supplier outreach in priority destinations
- First 20 creators signed and briefed
- First destination offers live in two cities
- Weekly management review running with the dashboard

Weeks 9–13

Scale and learn

- Referral programme and reviews workflow live
- At-risk and win-back journeys live
- Festive-season campaign through the campaign launch workflow
- First quarterly partner and creator reviews
- First quarterly consent and data review
- Review every KPI against target and reset for next quarter

Check yourself

1. A guest leaves a 2-star review the day after check-out. What happens first?

Send them a discount code for the next trip

Personal reply within 48 hours and a service-recovery ticket

Wait for the monthly review digest

Answer: Three stars or fewer get a personal reply and a support ticket (reviews workflow W4), then service recovery (W5). The supplier hears within a day.

2. A new member signed up 10 days ago and hasn't booked. Which stage are they in?

L3 Join

At-risk

L2 Explore

Answer: They have an account, so they are in Join. They become At-risk only after 60 days with no visit, or 90 days without booking.

3. A hot B2C enquiry arrives at 11 am. How fast should a person reply?

Within 1 working day

Within 15 minutes

Within 2 hours

Answer: Acknowledge automatically within 1 minute, a human reply within 15 minutes in working hours, and a quote within 2 hours.

4. An employee's business trip is within the company's travel policy. Who approves it?

Their manager, always

Nobody: it can be booked straight away

Finance

Answer: Only trips outside policy go to the approver. In-policy trips are booked directly, which is what makes corporate travel fast.

5. Which number is our north star?

App installs

Completed trips × average booking value

Marketing spend

Answer: It counts the value of trips people actually took, which every channel contributes to.

Words you'll hear**GBV**

Gross booking value: the total value of bookings before costs, refunds excluded.

North star

The one number the whole company steers by: completed bookings × average booking value.

CAC

Customer acquisition cost: marketing spend ÷ new customers who booked.

CPI

Cost per install: paid spend ÷ app installs from paid campaigns.

Cohort

A group that joined in the same period, followed over time, e.g. everyone who signed up in October.

Attribution

Linking a booking to what caused it: a campaign tag, a creator link or a code.

Conversion

The share of people who move from one stage to the next, e.g. sign-up to first booking.

Median

The middle value when sorted. Used for times so that one extreme case does not distort the result.

Leading KPI

Moves first and can be changed this week, e.g. opt-in rate. Managed weekly.

Lagging KPI

Confirms the result later, e.g. repeat rate. Reviewed monthly or quarterly.

NPS

Net Promoter Score: % answering 9–10 minus % answering 0–6 to "How likely are you to recommend us?".

Rate parity

Vacario's price for a stay is the same as or better than other sites.

SLA

Service level: the time allowed for a step, e.g. reply within 15 minutes.

UGC

User-generated content: photos, videos and reviews made by travellers.

Tier-1 media

National business and travel outlets on an agreed, fixed list.

ASCI

Advertising Standards Council of India, whose guidelines require paid creator posts to be clearly labelled.

MICE

Meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions: company group travel and events.

OTA

Online travel agency, such as MakeMyTrip, Cleartrip or Booking.com.

💡 Try this on Monday

1. Pick the one week-1 task that is yours, and start it today.
2. Send this page to one colleague and ask them to play stop 5.